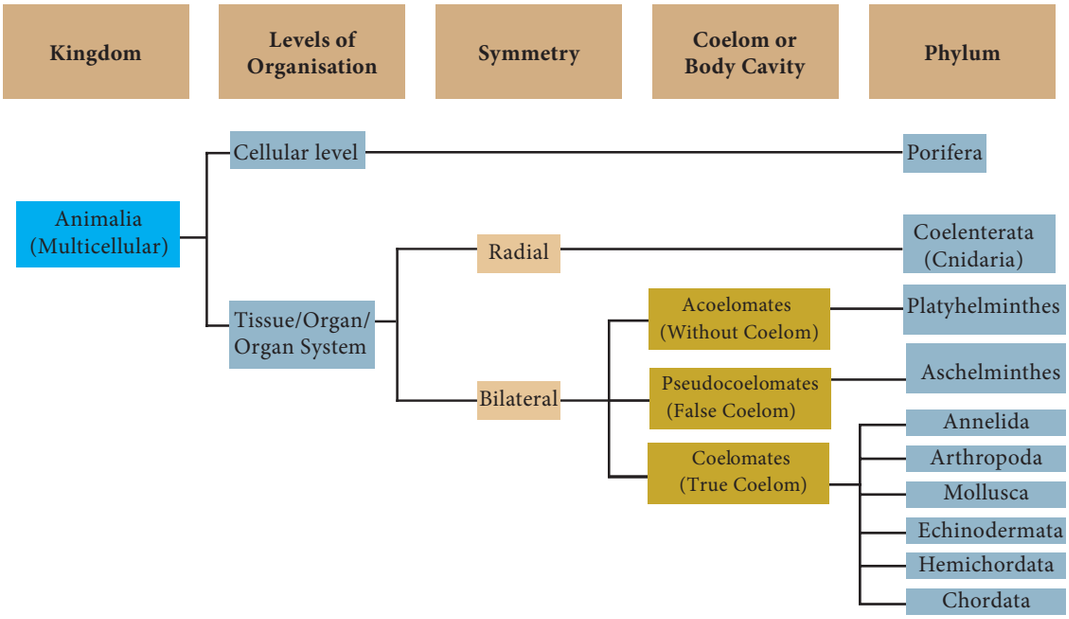
Classification of kingdom Animalia based on fundamental features



diploblastic animals. e.g Hydra. Organisms with three germ layers, ectoderm, mesoderm and endoderm are called **triploblastic** animals. e.g Rabbit

Coelom: It is a fluid-filled body cavity. It separates the digestive tract from the body wall. A true body cavity or coelom is one that is located within the mesoderm. Based on the nature of the coelom, animals are divided into 3 groups.

1. Acoelomates do not have a body cavity e.g Tapeworm.
2. Pseudocoelomates have a false body cavity e.g Roundworm.
3. Coelomates or Eucoelomates have a true coelom e.g Earthworm, Frog.

Animal Kingdom is further divided into two groups based on the presence or absence of notochord as below.

1. Invertebrata
2. Chordata-Prochordata and Vertebrata

Animals which do not possess notochord are called as **Invertebrates** or **Non- chordates**. Animals which possess notochord or backbone are called as **Chordates**. You have already studied the characters of single celled protozoans.

More to Know

Notochord is a rod like structure formed on the mid-dorsal side of the body during embryonic development. Except primitive forms in which the notochord persists throughout life in all other animals it is replaced by a backbone.

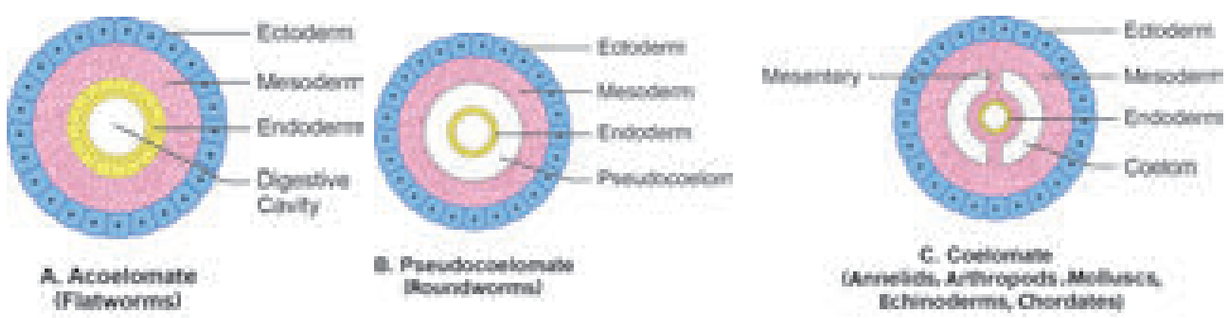


Figure 17.2 Types of Coelom

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